

Interesting Tools

Grunt

Grunt is a JavaScript task runner that's used to automate repetitive tasks such as minification, unit testing, linting etc. Configure a Gruntfile and the task runner does everything else. Twitter and Adobe actively use Grunt.

Mocha

Mocha is a testing framework for JavaScript that allows you to perform both synchronous or asynchronous tests. It is hosted on Github.

MongoDB

It is a document based NoSQL database. It offers fast querying and updating, flexible aggregation and data processing. It is easy to scale and uses internal memory for storing current data which enables faster access.

Sinon

Sinon is a Javascript library which provides spies, stubs and mocks for JavaScript. A Spy is a function that records metrics passed to it. A stub is a spy with some preprogrammed functionality. It can perform actions based on the metrics passed to it.

The four tools mentioned above only graze the surface of the vast amount of readymade tools available for JavaScript. There's probably a tool for almost every need, and if there isn't it's easy to write your own, but remember to make it free for others to use.

Tools to learn JavaScript

W3Schools for HTML and CSS

To learn JavaScript you must have some basic knowledge of HTML and CSS. For that w3schools provides some fairly good step by step tutorials for the bare basics. It should be used only as a quick reference tool though since as a learning tool it doesn't quite measure up. www.w3schools.com

The Mozilla developer network

The Mozilla Developer Network is a also good place to start. It always has freshly updated content, is well maintained and has thousands of documents on a variety of subjects such as HTML5, Node, Javascript etc. <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/>